

WEAVING SUCCESS

Ms Suchita Oswal Jain, the Vice Chairman and JMD of India's leading textile conglomerate Vardhman Textiles, is the epitome of passion and perseverance. A devoted mother and a focused businesswoman, she is nurturing a billion-dollar enterprise with the utmost grit and determination.

Bashing the male dominance in the textile space, Ms Suchita joined Vardhman in 1990 with a strong vision to excel and set the benchmark in the textile industry. It was perfect timing for Ms Suchita to bring in her fresh ideas and knowledge into the business to drive transformation, since the India was opening its economy to the rest of the world. Currently, the group exports to over 75 countries, catering to global fashion and lifestyle brands including GAP, Uniqlo, Marks & Spencer, Target, H&M and Muji for their fabric requirements besides being a major supplier of yarns to companies/brands like Toyobo, Decathlon and Aditya Birla Group amongst others.

Besides, the market leader is equipped with dedicated design and technology cells to keep them at par with the changing needs. The Textile Pioneer Established in the year 1965 and headquartered in Ludhiana, Vardhman employs over 30,000 people, 35% of which are women across the country. Having a spindle count of 1.2 million, Vardhman has carved a niche in the market by delivering customer satisfaction at all times. "The

firm wants to stay ahead on sustainability curve and be an active participant in shaping the world we want. We consistently work towards bettering our performance – incrementally and through trailblazing innovations. Also, we have taken a major leap by establishing a one-of-a-kind fibre recycling plant wherein pre-consumer textile waste is consumed as the raw material and quality-controlled manufacturing of yarn from the recycled fibre is ensured" says Ms Suchita.

Ms Suchita is focused on new market development, determined to not only maintain the company's lead in India but to lead globally as well. "To achieve this we have increased our capacity, product range, category and mix while working on our technology, quality, innovation and product development." Ms Suchita adds.

Vardhman Group has always believed in leadership through excellence, which it achieves through a culture of innovation and continuous improvement.

Ms Suchita believes that skill development and education bring empowerment in the

true sense. The same reflects in the initiatives the company takes to bring women into the mainstream. "My focus across all company initiatives is to ensure that women are given equal opportunities of growth and for that we have created training workshops and leadership modules.

We offer a conducive work environment with the reassurance that any discomfort women feel will be treated with utmost sensitivity" she adds. Leadership mantra - an able custodian of her family business, who has worked up the ladder starting as an Executive Director to the position of Vice Chairman & JMD, Ms Suchita suggests that entrepreneurship is a journey of continuous learning, where one needs to focus on the goal besides having an eye for detail. She says once you decide on a goal for yourself, never stop until you attain it. "Clarity in vision, long-term perspective, detail-oriented outlook and one-step ahead approach besides understanding the value of resources and utilizing them to the optimum would be on my list of 'attributes required' to progress as a leader" Ms Suchita adds.